

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The balance sheet the republic opened with

COLONIAL LIABILITY (economic and administrative)		MOVEMENT ASSET (political)
dependent, stagnant, famine-prone economy		tested all-India leadership
mass illiteracy and low life expectancy		party organised in every province
rentier agriculture, rising landlessness		democracy, civil liberties, secularism
apparatus built for extraction and order		three decades of practised organisation

CENTRAL QUESTION -> how did the second column carry the first without collapsing?

ERROR TO AVOID -> merging the columns and crediting the empire with Indian democracy.

MUST REMEMBER: Colonial legacies included centralised administration, civil services, army, law, railways, economic underdevelopment and classificatory practices, while the national movement supplied democratic and federal resources.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: How underdevelopment was developed

SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION with the world capitalist system since the 1750s

- > forced international division of labour: raw materials out, manufactures in
 - > real change in railways, administration, education, finance and communications
 - > but change operating INSIDE a colonial frame crystallises a dependent structure
 - > poverty, dependence and subordination reproduced rather than growth generated
- ATTRIBUTION -> the phrase development of underdevelopment belongs to A. Gunder Frank.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The agrarian legacy in attributed numbers

MEASURE	SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE
per capita agricultural production	falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941
per capita foodgrains	falls further than total production
landless agricultural labourers	about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951
land controlled by landlords by the 1940s	reported as over 70% in the local text
STRUCTURE -> landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state	
INCENTIVE -> rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The human baseline of 1951

MEASURE	SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 unless stated)
illiteracy, all Indians	nearly 84 per cent
illiteracy, women	about 92 per cent; about 8 literate women in every 100
life expectancy at birth	barely 32 years for an Indian born between 1940 and 1951
death rate, 1941-50	about 25 per 1,000 persons a year
infant mortality	between 175 and 190 per 1,000 live births
CAUSE -> colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The state that was kept rather than dismantled

INHERITED APPARATUS

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|-- AUTHORITARIAN CORE -> repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent
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|                        -> wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police
|                        -> collector and district magistrate in one office
|-- LIBERAL FRAGMENTS -> rule of law | relatively independent judiciary
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|                        -> press, speech and association tolerated in calm periods
`-- REPUBLIC'S TASK     -> convert an instrument of order and extraction into one of development
THESES -> continuity with conversion, not rupture; that conversion is the real legacy problem.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Three franchises, one break

AFTER 1919 | about 3 per cent of Indians could vote | legislatures with little power
AFTER 1935 | about 15 per cent could vote | supreme power still with the British
REPUBLIC | universal adult franchise | free and fair elections by right
COLONIAL PURPOSE -> co-opt and weaken the national movement while keeping the reins
UNINTENDED EFFECT -> Indians gain practical experience of elections and elected organs
THE BREAK -> the republic replaced the colonial franchise; it did not widen it by degrees.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Movement assets converted into republican institutions

NATIONAL MOVEMENT

|-- LEADERSHIP -> Nehru | Patel | Azad | Rajendra Prasad -> no single region or community
|-- BREADTH -> first Nehru cabinet of fourteen includes five non-Congressmen
| -> B.R. Ambedkar chairs the Drafting Committee
|-- HABITS -> accommodative politics; three decades of elections, argument, organisation
`-- CONVERSION -> all-India services and a national army on merit, under civilian control
LATER COST -> the same dominance becomes the Congress system whose decay is a later topic.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Four pressures in the same months

COMMUNAL VIOLENCE -> refugee movement, killing, minority insecurity
TELANGANA INSURGENCY -> armed communist challenge inside the new republic
PRINCELY INTEGRATION -> more than 560 units to accede, merge and democratise
CONTESTED FRONTIER -> fighting and an international reference in Kashmir
PLUS -> a divided army and a divided treasury inherited on the first day
METHOD -> secular reassurance + coercive capacity + reconciliation, democracy not suspended
CONSEQUENCE -> the constitutional preference for a strong centre and emergency provisions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Reading the two most misused figures

FIGURE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT IS NOT
nearly six million	refugees ENTERING India	total displacement both ways
roughly 500,000 dead	Chandra's estimate	settled or agreed scholarship
WEST FLOW -> largely one movement in 1947; land vacated; resettled substantially by 1951		
EAST FLOW -> continuous migration from East Bengal; little land; urban underclass formed		
SAFE SENTENCE -> name the author, mark the direction, record that other scholarship differs.		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: From assassination to the lifted ban

JAN 1948 -> after a fast by Gandhi, Rs 550 million paid to Pakistan (assets settlement)

30 JAN 1948 -> Gandhi assassinated by Nathuram Godse -> communalism retreats sharply

IMMEDIATE -> Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh banned; leaders and functionaries arrested

JUN 1949 -> Nehru records a preference for fewer bans and detentions

JULY 1949 -> ban lifted on accepted conditions: written and published constitution,
cultural activity only, no violence or secrecy, loyalty to flag and
Constitution, democratic internal organisation

READING -> proscription used and then withdrawn on terms, not permanent suppression.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: A railway, court or bureaucracy is not inherently a benevolent gift or an
unchanged colonial burden; purpose, access, financing, adaptation and post-1947 political
control must be separated.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Insurrection converted into opposition

LATE 1946 -> Communist-led peasant struggle develops in Telangana inside Hyderabad state

FEB 1948 -> B.T. Ranadive line declares independence false and adopts armed struggle

1948-51 -> insurgency contained by the state while the political door is kept open

MID-1951 -> Telangana struggle called off; the parliamentary path is adopted

THEN -> party legalised everywhere; leaders and cadres released; elections contested

LESSON -> the armed challenge was defeated and the party was not abolished.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nationalist, Marxist, Cambridge, subaltern and feminist readings require sector-specific evidence rather than a single positive-versus-negative balance sheet.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Four domains, two dates and one completed map

POLITY -> integration, Constitution 26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950, universal adult franchise
LIMIT: strong-centre bias and unresolved regional questions

ECONOMY -> planned, state-led development with a public-sector core and land-reform law
LIMIT: slow growth and land reform largely unimplemented

EDUCATION -> from about 84 per cent illiteracy to deliberate scientific and technical investment
LIMIT: elite-first expansion; primary and female education lag badly

INT. REL. -> non-alignment and Asian solidarity; Pondicherry 1954; Goa 17 December 1961
LIMIT: limited hard power

TWO DATES -> independence 15 Aug 1947 | republic 26 Jan 1950; the 2026 parade is the 77th
precisely because 1950 counts as the first

DO NOT CONFUSE -> Operation Vijay (Goa, Dec 1961) with Operation Polo (Hyderabad, Sep 1948).